problem, because these are adversaries with authoritarian regimes. Whereas in the open societies of democratic countries it is not difficult for a professional intelligence body to uncover the leadership's intentions, this is not the case in countries with authoritarian regimes, in which only a tiny number of people are exposed to the leader's intentions and in which sometimes intentions can be found only inside the head of the ruler. For example, Egyptian president Anwar Sadat informed senior Egyptian military commanders of the exact date of the launch of the attack against Israel in October 1973 only a few days prior to that date. This does not contradict the contention (in the chapter on the Yom Kippur War) that Sadat's intention to go to war against Israel began to crystallize in 1971.

The intensity of the hostility toward Israel, the level of involvement, and the degree of commitment of each member of the Arab coalition have changed over the years, and this has made it even more difficult to expose and identify Arab intentions vis-à-vis Israel, as well as to accurately assess threat perception (the threat to Israel attributed to one factor or another).

In a war of intelligence, each side strives to preserve its secrets, as it defines them. In this respect, the models of the United States and the Soviet Union during the Cold War (1945–90) make an interesting case study of completely different perceptions of operations security. This difference in perception was a direct function of the United States being an open society with a democratic regime and the Soviet Union being a state with a dictatorial regime.

The Soviet regime made a decision that all information about itself—100 percent of it, nothing less—and anything related to it was considered confidential. The result was that all information was inserted, figuratively speaking, into a black and opaque box that was guarded zealously. In contrast, the Americans decided to include only about 5 percent of all information in the "black box," the tiny portion that it believed that, if exposed, would severely damage the main components of American power. There was not even an effort to guard the other 95 percent.

It is not difficult to understand that the Soviet model could be successful only if the box was well and truly sealed. One break-in would reveal all of the information inside to the adversary.

The American model was based on the assumption that protecting 100 percent of the information was an impossible task and that it was therefore better to protect only 5 percent. As for everything else, the assumption was